Kristal DeCoux

Web Strategy and Conversion Leader

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Summary

Web strategy and conversion leader with 15+ years running enterprise websites as demand-generation engines for B2B SaaS and consumer brands. Built or relaunched the website testing programs at AWS and Elastic: 46% of the first 50 AWS tests won, and Elastic's trial flow tests lifted Cloud trial signups 69%. At Ancestry, tests I owned added $4.8M in annualized revenue. Today I lead Elastic.co (~2M monthly visitors, 8 languages) and a 16-person team across web development, UX, experimentation, SEO/LLMO, localization, and web merchandising, with the intake, governance, and testing processes that let marketing ship faster without giving up quality or conversion.

Core strengths: Web Strategy and Demand Gen · Conversion Rate Optimization and Experimentation · Web Analytics and Measurement · UX, IA and Design Systems · Content Operations and Intake · Web Development and Platform Governance · SEO and Answer-Engine Optimization · Team Leadership and Operating Rhythm

Professional experience

Elastic · Remote

Director, Web Strategy & Development — Aug 2025 – Present

Own Elastic.co (~2M monthly visitors, 8 languages), the primary self-serve entry point for Elastic Cloud trials. Lead a 16-person team: 7 direct reports (an engineering manager with 9 engineers, a localization program manager, SEO content strategist, UX designer, UX engineer, testing manager, and technical program manager) across web development, UX design and research, experimentation, SEO/LLMO, localization, and web merchandising.

- Led the redesign of the homepage, platform page, and solutions pages with the internal team, replacing a 3+ year old agency design and shipping one day ahead of the deadline.
- After the redesign, the share of visitors reaching the bottom of the homepage rose from <9% to ~25%, visibility of solutions content from ~20% to ~60%, and security solution click-through rate (CTR) from <1% to ~4%.
- Migrated Elastic Labs from Sanity and a GitHub/Vercel pipeline to Contentstack, consolidating Labs onto the same CMS as the rest of elastic.co.
- Improved the SEO content pipeline and published an SEO review skill that content authors run in their own Claude instance on draft copy, producing keyword and content recommendations, page schema, and title/description metadata. SEO content is appearing more often in AI answers and overviews since the change.
- Moving web intake from Workfront to GitHub: consolidated 16 request templates into 6, added effort tiers and scoping documentation, and built a Claude triage skill that cut request triage from ~1 hour to seconds and flags incomplete requests. A Workfront-to-GitHub sync built with Marketing Operations is ~90% complete.
- Run a business-aligned web roadmap with engineering, product marketing, brand, design, and regional teams, with defined prioritization, scoping, and cross-team handoffs that balance always-on intake with strategic initiatives.
- Leading information architecture work to improve discoverability for people and AI search, including topic-based structure for concept content under /resources/learn/ and schema that cross-links concept and product pages (in progress).

Director, Website Strategy — Mar 2025 – Jul 2025

- Led research and strategy for the homepage redesign around developer-first messaging and clearer product journeys.
- Modernized information architecture and URL structure to align with user goals and improve discoverability.
- Ran the A/B testing and personalization program to improve content relevance and conversion; drove search and AI answer-engine visibility strategy.

Director, Optimization & Conversion — Oct 2021 – Mar 2025

- Relaunched and matured the Elastic.co experimentation program, building frameworks for hypothesis generation, documentation, analysis, and org-wide sharing.
- Led a three-test series on the Elastic Cloud trial flow with product and UX teams: the trial page redesign lifted trial signups 69% (trial starts +64%), and signup completion rose 95%.
- A homepage test lifted Cloud trial signups 73%.
- Mentored cross-functional partners in test design and user behavior analysis.

Amazon Web Services (AWS) · Seattle, WA / Remote

Head of Website Analytics & Testing May 2021 – Oct 2021

- Led a team of 5 (3 business analysts, 2 testing specialists) supporting the global AWS marketing website, delivering KPI dashboards and insight on how web experiences drive conversion and lead generation.
- Created Adobe Analytics training programs and self-serve dashboards to democratize data access for marketing stakeholders.

Head of Website Testing Apr 2020 – May 2021

- Founded the AWS website experimentation program: launched 50 A/B tests in the first 8 months with a 46% win rate, then grew test velocity 400% YoY.
- Built the operating rhythm: shared-responsibility support model, test planning and documentation standards, stakeholder ideation workshops, weekly office hours, and monthly/quarterly business reviews with leadership.

Sr. Product Manager, AWS Website Jan 2018 – Apr 2020

- Led a team of 6 (2 product managers, 4 digital marketing specialists); owned template strategy and optimization roadmap for product detail pages across 150+ services.
- Managed the migration of 800+ pages to new templates and web delivery for product launches at regional summits and annual conferences.
- Built engagement benchmarks and dashboards; ran quantitative and qualitative research and A/B tests (Adobe Experience Manager, Adobe Target, Tableau).

Digital Marketing Manager Dec 2016 – Jan 2018

- Led a cross-functional redesign of AWS product detail pages, grounded in an audit of 500+ pages across 75+ products, usability studies, card sorts, and focus groups in three cities.
- Built and analyzed paid-media landing pages; managed creative agencies; trained 50+ stakeholders on new page designs and CMS workflows.

Ancestry.com · San Francisco Bay Area

Marketing Manager, Conversion Optimization May 2015 – Nov 2016

- Tests I owned added $4.8M in annualized revenue; helped grow the testing program from 25 to 300+ tests a year.
- Social-proof strategy on high-volume entry pages lifted conversion 10%+, adding ~$20K revenue/month.
- Search results page optimization lifted conversion 3% and retention 5% (+$54K revenue/month); DNA homepage conversion up 5%; cross-sell rate up to 5% across segments.
- Lifted channel-level conversion 2–8% through targeted experiences by referrer and sub-channel; supported paid search, SEO, content, social, and email with landing-page optimization.

Conversion Analyst Mar 2012 – May 2015

- Designed and analyzed A/B tests across major touchpoints using SQL and Adobe tools; set sample sizes and test lengths; delivered recommendations to executive stakeholders.

Project Manager, Analytics May 2011 – Mar 2012

- Built the analytics team's request intake, ticketing workflow, and monthly prioritization process; managed vendor contracts.

Education

University of San Francisco · Professional Certificate, Web Analytics (2012)

Utah Valley University · Business Administration/Marketing (2009–2013)

University of Louisiana at Lafayette · General Studies (2000–2003)

Tools and platforms

Web platforms and ops: Contentstack, Adobe Experience Manager, GitHub, Adobe Workfront, Jira, Confluence

Experimentation and analytics: Optimizely, Adobe Target, Adobe Analytics, Google Analytics, FullStory, ContentSquare, CrazyEgg, SQL, Tableau

Research, design and AI: Figma, Maze, Wynter, usability testing, card sorting; Claude (custom skills and workflow automation)